



Food remedy Co. API

Name: Dhriti Jain

Student ID: 222315437

Ticket: RE022

Table of Contents

RE022 - Impact of Nutrition Labels and Food Scoring on Consumer Decision-Making.....	1
Introduction	1
Comparing Scoring Formats.....	4
Decision Speed.....	5
Confusion Points in Traditional Nutrition Labels	5
Score-based vs Label-based Decision Making	5
Key Insights and Behavioural Patterns.....	6
Conclusion	6
References	7

RE022 - Impact of Nutrition Labels and Food Scoring on Consumer Decision-Making

Introduction

Nutrition labels and food scoring systems are intended to help people understand the foods they consume and make healthier choices. Nutrition labels present detailed information about a product's nutritional content, including serving size, calorie information, and the levels of different nutrients, whereas food scoring systems present users with a standard score to assess how healthy certain foods are and allow for quick comparison.

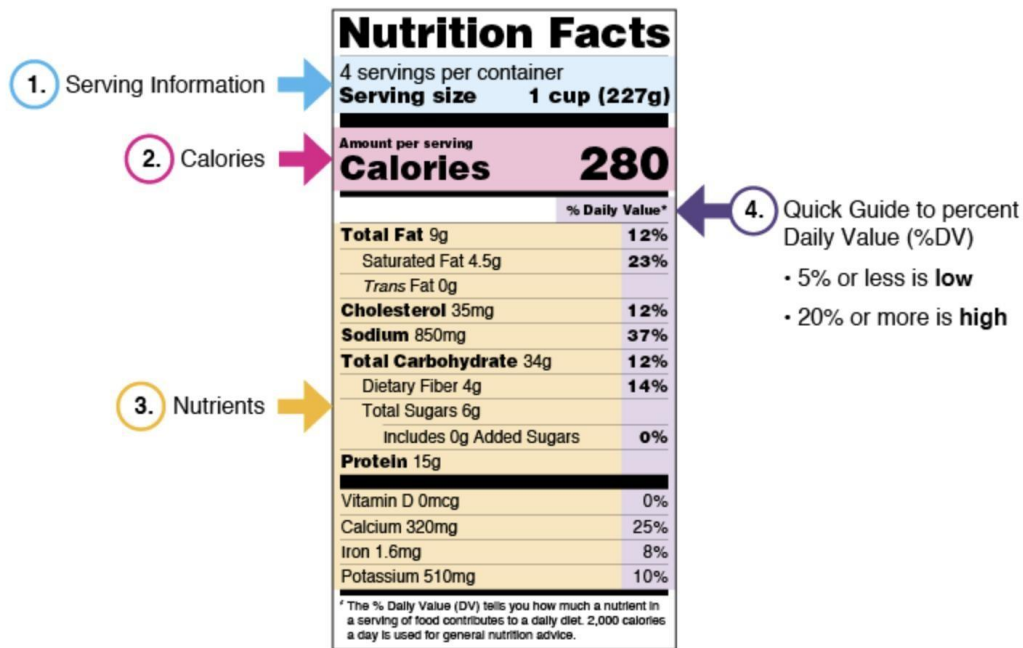


Image Source: <https://www.fda.gov/food/nutrition-facts-label/how-understand-and-use-nutrition-facts-label>

Yuka employs a color-coded rating system with a numerical score ranging from 0 to 100. Every product is given a score between 0 and 100, which results in a color-coded rating: green is for high scores for healthy options, yellow for intermediate scores, and red for food with a low nutritional value. According to the Nutri-Score methodology, 60% of the score is determined by nutritional content, 30% by the addition of additives, and 10% by organic dimension.

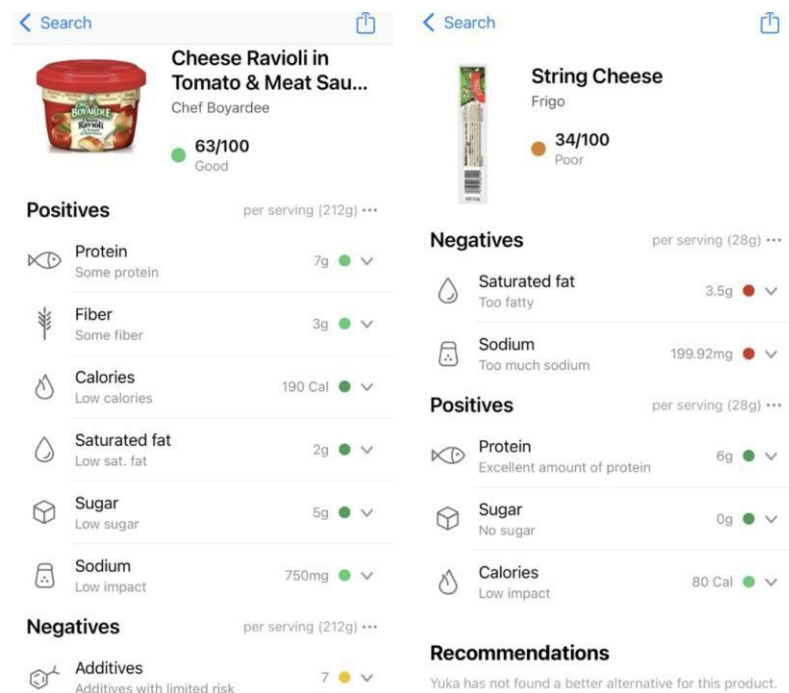
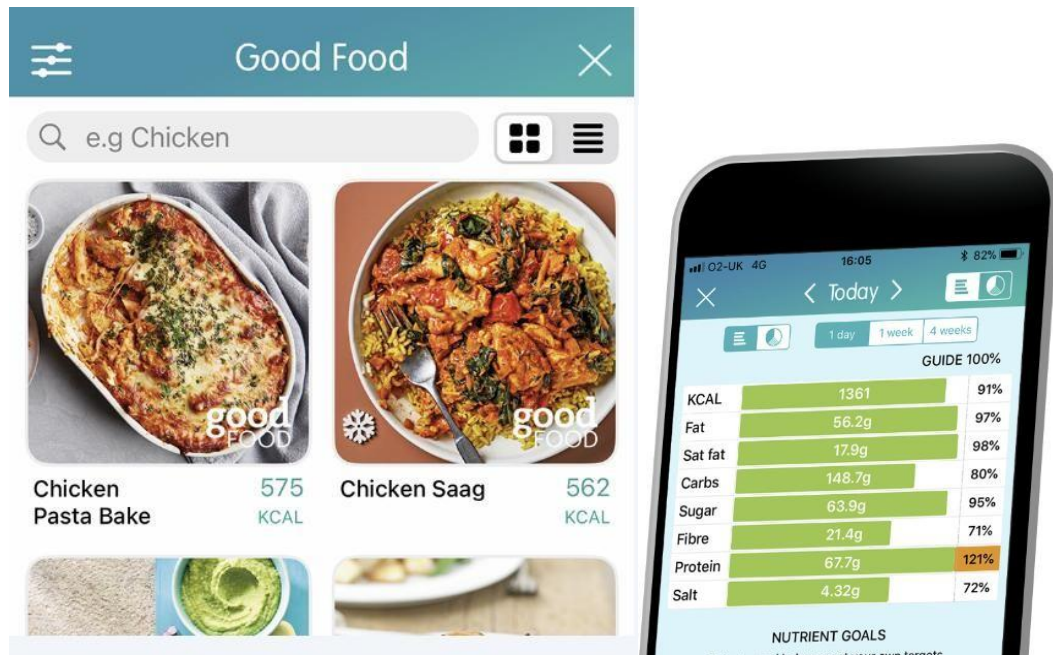


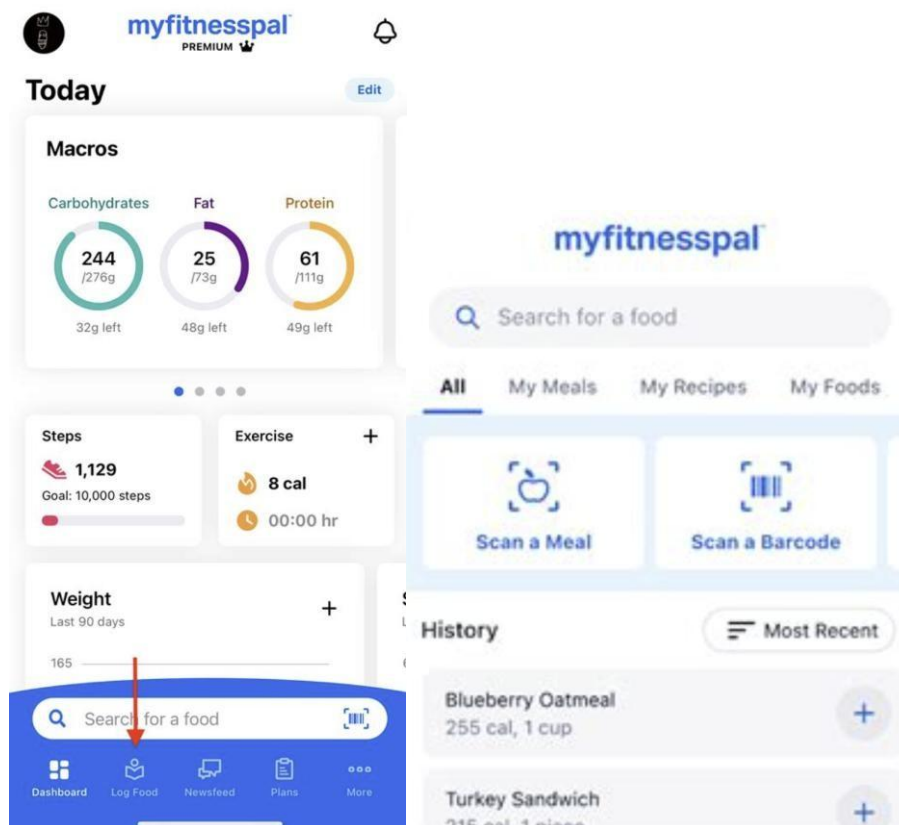
Image source: <https://mamaknowsnutrition.com/yuka-app-reviews/>

NutraCheck, on the other hand, employs a different approach. It doesn't assign an overall product score but instead tracks nutrients and calories. It tracks 6 key nutrients including carbs, protein, fat, saturated fat, sugar and salt, and fibre with barcode scanning and food entries through a food diary. The app focuses on quantitative self-monitoring rather than evaluative scoring.



Images source: <https://www.nutracheck.com/Info/TheBestCalorieCounterandFoodDiary>

MyFitnessPal, similarly, centres on calorie and macro nutrient tracking. To log food intake, users either scan a food barcode, Meal Scan, a vast pre-existing food menu with options for selecting different portion sizes or estimating calories for recipes through the portion size of the ingredients. It has a really big food database with over 18 million items which include packaged, fresh and restaurant foods. The app also takes into account the calories burnt through exercise.



Images source: <https://fitness-n-health.com/how-to-track-food-on-my-fitness-pal.html>

Comparing Scoring Formats

Scoring Format	Description	Example App	Advantage	Limitation					
Grades (A–E)	Products are rated using letter grades based on overall health	Yuka's underlying algorithm	Very easy to understand, quick decisions	Oversimplifies nutrition details					
Numerical Scores (/100)	Foods are given a score based on nutritional quality	Yuka	Allows quick comparison between products	Oversimplification , does not consider things like natural sugars					
Colour Indicators (Traffic Light)	Red, amber and green color coding for individual ingredients Each burger contains: <table border="1"> <tr> <td>ENERGY 924kJ 220kcal 11%</td> <td>FAT 13g MED 19%</td> <td>SATURATES 5.9g HIGH 30%</td> <td>SUGARS 0.8g LOW <1%</td> <td>SALT 0.7g MED 12%</td> </tr> </table> % of an adults reference intake. Typical values per 100g: Energy 966kJ/ 230kcal	ENERGY 924kJ 220kcal 11%	FAT 13g MED 19%	SATURATES 5.9g HIGH 30%	SUGARS 0.8g LOW <1%	SALT 0.7g MED 12%	NutraCheck display	Highly intuitive and visual	Lower importance to taste attributes
ENERGY 924kJ 220kcal 11%	FAT 13g MED 19%	SATURATES 5.9g HIGH 30%	SUGARS 0.8g LOW <1%	SALT 0.7g MED 12%					

	Image source: https://www.nhs.uk/livewell/eat-well/foodguidelines-and-foodlabels/how-to-read-foodlabels/			
Detailed Nutritional Data	Shows calories, macros, and micronutrients	MyFitnessPal , NutraCheck	High transparency and accuracy	Time-consuming to interpret

Decision Speed

By eliminating the need for in-depth study, simplified scoring systems greatly increase decision speed. Visual signals such as colors or scores allow users to rapidly compare products. Detailed nutritional panels, on the other hand, slow down decision-making and raise cognitive strain as they require time and understanding to interpret.

Confusion Points in Traditional Nutrition Labels

Although estimated use of nutrition labels is high, actual use during food purchases is far less. Customers are able to comprehend particular terms, but as tasks become increasingly complex, they are less able to accurately interpret labels. Understanding quantitative data, interpreting serving sizes, and utilizing percentage daily values are among specific interpretation challenges. While most consumers are able to discover calorie content, fewer are able to apply proportion information to estimate contribution to daily diet. Research recommends incorporating interpretive labels, fewer percentages, and clear serving size presentation to simplify label complexity and communicate quantitative nutrition information.

Score-based vs Label-based Decision Making

There are two distinct methods for directing food choices: label-based and score-based systems. Label-based systems, like those found in MyFitnessPal, offer comprehensive nutritional data, such as ingredient lists, calories, and macronutrients, enabling consumers to make transparent and well-informed selections. However, interpreting this method takes more time and effort. On the other hand, score-based systems, like Yuka's, simplify complicated data into unambiguous ratings or color indicators, facilitating quicker and easier decisionmaking. Score-based systems may oversimplify nutritional information and restrict deeper knowledge, even while they increase usability and lessen cognitive strain. In general, users tend to rely on label-based systems when accuracy and precision are more crucial, but they prefer score-based techniques for speedy selections.

Key Insights and Behavioural Patterns

Simplified and visually appealing nutrition information is clearly preferred by users. By condensing complicated nutritional data into simple ratings or color indicators, scoring systems like Yuka's promote quicker decision-making. Users' views of healthiness are greatly influenced by these visual signals, which frequently cause them to depend more on scores than on careful label analysis. This can lead to an over-reliance on simplified information even while it speeds up decision-making and lowers cognitive effort. According to research, people are more inclined to interact with and trust systems that strike a balance between transparency and clarity, including integrating scores with easily accessible nutritional information. Simplified scoring systems often improve usability and lessen decision fatigue, but they must be carefully crafted to prevent inaccurate or insufficient interpretations of food quality.

Conclusion

By streamlining complicated nutritional data and facilitating quicker decision-making, nutrition score systems greatly increase usability. Yuka and other apps show how visual scoring can lessen decision fatigue and uncertainty. But depending only on simplified scores could prevent further in-depth comprehension. The best strategy for encouraging knowledgeable and self-assured eating choices is a well-rounded one that incorporates easy-to-access precise information with transparent scoring.

References

- Barnes, K. (2025, Jul 24). *Yuka App Reviews: the Truth from a Registered Dietitian*. Retrieved from mama knows nutrition: <https://mamaknowsnutrition.com/yuka-app-reviews/>
- Dunn, L. (2025, May 20). *I Tested Yuka, the Wildly Popular Grocery App*. Retrieved from Consumed: <https://consumed.substack.com/p/why-i-dont-use-the-yuka-app-when>
- Food labels*. (2022, Sep 16). Retrieved from NHS: <https://www.nhs.uk/live-well/eat-well/food-guidelines-and-food-labels/how-to-read-food-labels/>
- Simmons, R. (2026, Mar 13). *How To Track Food On My Fitness Pal?* Retrieved from Fitness and Health: <https://fitness-n-health.com/how-to-track-food-on-my-fitness-pal.html>
- Superfast Calorie Counter & Food Diary*. (n.d.). Retrieved from NutraCheck: <https://www.nutracheck.com/Home>
- The Yuka App - Food & Cosmetic Scanner Review by Experts*. (2026, Apr 22). Retrieved from GreenChoice: <https://about.greenchoicenow.com/resources/yuka-app>
- What Can You Learn From a Nutrition Label?* (2024, Jun 19). Retrieved from Cleveland Clinic: <https://health.clevelandclinic.org/how-to-read-a-nutrition-label>
- Cowburn, G., & Stockley, L. (2005). Consumer understanding and use of nutrition labelling: a systematic review. *Public health nutrition*, 8(1), 21–28. <https://doi.org/10.1079/phn2005666>
- Moore SG, Donnelly JK, Jones S, Cade JE. Effect of Educational Interventions on Understanding and Use of Nutrition Labels: A Systematic Review. *Nutrients*. 2018 Oct 4;10(10):1432. doi: 10.3390/nu10101432. PMID: 30287766; PMCID: PMC6213388.
- Zhang X, Liu Y, Gu Y, Wang S, Chen H. Red for "Stop": "Traffic-Light" Nutrition Labels Decrease Unhealthy Food Choices by Increasing Activity and Connectivity in the Frontal Lobe. *Nutrients*. 2020 Jan 2;12(1):128. doi: 10.3390/nu12010128. PMID: 31906493; PMCID: PMC7019506.